

YOUR FULL REPORT

Do you push people away?

Distance as protection

Score band: 27–35 points · Relationships

What this report covers

A step-by-step guide for interrupting a strong push-pull cycle before it costs you connection.

Inside:

1. Your withdrawal sequence
2. Reality-checking fear before acting
3. Building tolerance for dependable care

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Your result

Distance as protection (27–35 points)

Your answers suggest a strong push-pull pattern: wanting connection while treating it as a threat. Safe relationships may improve when you name fear before acting on it.

Try this next

Notice the moment before withdrawal. What are you predicting will happen—and what evidence supports it?

Your practical guide

A step-by-step guide for interrupting a strong push-pull cycle before it costs you connection.

1 Your withdrawal sequence

Your withdrawal likely follows a sequence, and sequences can be interrupted once you see them. It often starts with a closeness spike — a great date, a deep conversation, someone saying they care about you. Then comes the scan: suddenly their laugh annoys you, their texts feel demanding, you feel trapped by plans you happily made. Then the pullback: delayed replies, busyness, emotional flatness. Finally the story that justifies it: "I am just not feeling it" or "they are too much." Map your last two cycles against these four steps. The pattern is not proof the relationship is wrong; it is proof your nervous system treats closeness as a threat to manage.

2 Reality-checking fear before acting

Before you act on the urge to pull away, run a two-minute reality check. Ask: what actually happened, in facts without interpretation? ("They texted twice today" — not "they are suffocating me.") What am I predicting, and what is the evidence? ("They will leave if I disappoint them" — have they?) What would I tell a friend in this exact spot? Then test the fear with the smallest possible experiment: reply warmly once, keep one plan, share one small vulnerability — and watch what actually happens. Most of the time, the catastrophe does not arrive, and each survived experiment weakens the alarm. You are not arguing yourself out of fear; you are collecting counter-evidence.

3 Building tolerance for dependable care

Dependable care feels dangerous when your system learned that closeness comes with a cost — so you practice tolerating it in doses. Start absurdly small: let someone do one kind thing without deflecting it. No "you shouldn't have," no immediate repayment, just "thank you, that meant a lot." Then extend the dose: accept a compliment without a self-deprecating chaser, let a friend sit with you in a hard moment instead of performing fine. After each dose, notice that you survived the vulnerability and the person stayed. Tolerance builds the way muscles do — through repetition at the edge of comfort, not through one heroic leap.